

Opening The Call (First 5 Minutes)

The opening sets the tone for everything. Master this 5-minute window to disarm tension and take command of the call.

READ TIME

6 min read

LEVEL

Critical

LESSON

05 / 14

The 5 Minutes That Decide Everything

Your prospect joins the call braced for a pitch. **If you launch into selling in the first 60 seconds, you've lost.** The opening 5 minutes are about ONE thing: making them comfortable enough to be honest with you.

→ The 3 Goals Of The Opening

GOAL 1

Build Trust

They don't know you. They're guarded. Trust is built through small signals — your tone, your energy, your willingness to listen, your respect for their time.

GOAL 2

Take Control

The person leading the call closes the call. You must drive the conversation. NOT in a pushy way — in a calm, organised way. 'Here's how I'll run this...'

GOAL 3

Set The Frame

Tell them what the call will cover. Tell them you'll qualify them out if it's not a fit. This dual-purpose move disarms them AND positions you as selective.

→ The 4-Part Opening Script

PART 1

Warm Hello (15 seconds)

'Hey [Name] — how's it going?' Simple. Friendly. Wait for their response. Don't barrel in. Let them speak first.

PART 2

Quick Rapport (30-60 seconds)

Reference something specific from your prep. 'I saw on your site you're based in [location] — how long have you been doing roofing?' Specific = remembered. Generic 'how was your weekend' = forgettable.

PART 3

Permission Frame (60 seconds)

'Before I dive in — anything specific you wanted to cover today, or should I drive the conversation?' Almost always they'll say 'you can drive it.' Now they've GIVEN you permission to lead.

PART 4

Process Frame (90 seconds)

'Here's how I'll run this: I'll ask you 5-10 questions to understand your business. Then if I think I can help, I'll explain how we work and what it costs. If not, I'll tell you straight up. Sound good?'

→ The Full Opening In Action

COMPLETE OPENING SCRIPT (ROOFING NICHE)

YOU: Hey Mike — how's it going?

MIKE: Good, you?

YOU: Doing well, doing well. I saw on your website you've been doing roofing in Houston for about 8 years — that right?

MIKE: Yeah, going on 9 years actually.

YOU: Awesome — and your team's around 12 guys? That's a real operation.

MIKE: Yeah, 14 now actually.

YOU: Nice. Okay before I dive in — anything specific you wanted to cover today, or should I drive the conversation?

MIKE: You can drive it.

YOU: Cool. Here's how I'll run this: I'll ask you 8-10 questions about your business — get a real picture of where you are and where you want to be. Then if I think I can help, I'll explain exactly how we work and what it costs. If not — I'll just tell you straight. Cool?

MIKE: Sounds good.

YOU: Perfect. So Mike — walk me through your business...

→ Tonality Notes

- **Slow your speech down 20%.** Most people speak faster when nervous. Slow = confident.
- **Smile when you talk.** They can hear it. Energy lifts.
- **Use their name 2-3x in the opening.** Names build connection. Don't overdo it.
- **Lower your voice slightly at end of sentences.** Up-talk = uncertainty. Down = authority.
- **Don't laugh nervously.** If something's funny, laugh genuinely. If not, don't fill space with chuckles.

→ Opening Mistakes That Kill Calls

MISTAKE 1

The Apology Opening

'Hi Mike, thanks for taking the time, I really appreciate it, sorry to bother you...' Apologetic = low status. Don't apologise for the call THEY booked.

MISTAKE 2

The Small-Talk Black Hole

5 minutes of weather, weekends, and 'where are you based?' Wastes the call. 60 seconds of rapport is plenty. Then move on.

MISTAKE 3

The Immediate Pitch

'So we help roofers book more jobs through Facebook ads...' You pitched in 20 seconds. They tune out. They've heard this from 50 agencies.

MISTAKE 4

The Vague Process

'So we'll just have a chat and see where it goes' = no structure = they don't know what to expect. The Process Frame is non-negotiable.

MISTAKE 5

Not Letting Them Talk

You're so eager to set the frame that you skip the rapport question. They feel rushed. Always let them speak first after hello.

→ The Subtle Power Moves

MOVE 1

Use 'We' Language Early

'Let's see if we're a fit.' Not 'Let me see if I want to work with you.' 'We' implies collaboration, not interrogation.

MOVE 2

Casual Confidence

Speak like you'd talk to a colleague. Not stiff. Not over-professional. Conversational tone closes more than corporate tone.

MOVE 3

Ask Permission

'Cool if I ask you some questions?' Tiny request creates micro-commitments. Builds momentum of yes answers.

MOVE 4

Mirror Their Energy Slightly

If they're chill and casual, match that. If they're formal and business-y, match that. Mirroring builds rapport subconsciously.

→ Handling Awkward Openings

SCENARIO 1

They Answer Cold

'Hello?' (curt, distracted). YOU: 'Hey [Name] — it's [your name], we had a call booked for [time]. Is now still good?' Gives them an out OR a re-set.

SCENARIO 2

They're Late

Don't be passive aggressive. 'No worries Mike — glad we caught each other. Got 25 mins still cool?' Reset the timer. Don't punish.

SCENARIO 3

Bad Connection

'Hey Mike — sound's a bit dodgy, mind if we restart on Zoom/Google Meet? I'll send a link now.' Don't push through bad audio — kills rapport.

SCENARIO 4

They Want To Skip To Pricing

'Just send me the pricing.' YOU: 'Happy to — but pricing varies on what you need. Give me 5 questions and I'll quote properly. Faster than guessing.' Get them back on YOUR track.

→ The Mental Anchor: First 30 Seconds

THE ANCHOR

The first 30 seconds of your tone, energy, and confidence sets the entire call. Walk in calm, smiling, in control. They will mirror it. Walk in frantic, apologetic, eager — they'll mirror that too. YOU set the energy.

PRACTICE DRILL

Record Your Next 3 Call Openings.

Use Zoom or Loom to record. Listen back. Are you slow enough? Confident enough? Following the 4-part script? Self-coaching beats every paid coach. Do this for 10 calls and your opening will be world-class.

END OF LESSON 05

Opening = Mastered.

Now the most important part of the call — the questions that diagnose their real problem.

NEXT → QUALIFYING & DIAGNOSING